

INTRODUCTION

Communicating with others beyond the basic needs of survival is one of the basic characteristic that distinguishes humans from others in the realm of *creation*. With the advent of web 2.0 people willing to express themselves found a convenient platform in the form of blogging. It is said never before was there so little to say by so many people in so many words. Jokes apart, blogging is serious business and tools like WordPress make it easier.

Free Open Source blog tools like WordPress help you create and manage your blog site with near zero effort. WordPress is an open source CMS, often used as a blog publishing application powered by PHP and MySQL. It has many features including a plug in architecture and a templating (allows for widgets and themes among many other things) system. WordPress is the most popular blog software in use today.

Talking a little about the history of this beautiful tool, WordPress first appeared in 2003 as a collaboration between Matt Mullenweg and Mike Little in an attempt to folk b2 or cafelog, the precursor of WordPress. The name 'WordPress' was an offering by Christine Selleck, a friend of Mullenweg.

Wordpress is a feature full tool and nearly unparalleled as a blogging platform. By default, it has optimised search engine design including sophisticated permalink ability, spam filters, ability to tag posts in multiple categories, neat support for trackback and pingback standards and a very robust plugin architecture teamed up with a vast repository of plugins available making it a tweaker's heaven.

Working with WordPress on the move is also a no pain affair as native applications are available for most common platforms including but not limited to Android, iPhone/iPod Touch, and BlackBerry. Wordpress is used as an indispensable tool by a countable infinity of people, to name a few you wouldn't expect to be on the list: Central Intelligence Agency, Defense Intelligence Agency, Department of Education, Department of Energy, Department of Homeland Security, Department of State, Department of Treasury, Drug Enforcement Administration, Federal Bureau of Investigation, National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency and so on.

In this Fast Track, we will begin with the basics of WordPress and then move on to using Wordpress on its own hosted domain.